

Chicken Chettinad Recipe (Serves 8 People)

Ingredients

Main

- Chicken (bone-in) – **2 kg**
- Oil – **4 tbsp (60 ml)**

Onions & Tomatoes

- Large onions – **4 (700 g)**, finely chopped
- Medium tomatoes – **4 (500 g)**, finely chopped

Ginger Garlic

- Ginger – **50 g**
- Garlic – **50 g**
- Grind together to make paste (or use **2 tbsp ginger-garlic paste**)

Curry Leaves & Coriander

- Curry leaves – **20–25 leaves**
- Fresh coriander leaves – **1 handful**, chopped

Spices for Roasting

- Coriander seeds – **4 tbsp (32 g)**
- Fennel seeds – **2 tsp (8 g)**
- Cumin seeds – **2 tsp (8 g)**
- Whole black pepper – **2 tsp (8 g)**
- Dry red chilies – **10–12**
- Cloves – **4**
- Green cardamom – **2**
- Cinnamon – **2-inch piece**

Coconut

- Fresh grated coconut – **50 g (4–5 tbsp)**

Other

- Turmeric powder – **1 tsp**
 - Salt – **4–5 tsp total** (adjust to taste)
 - Hot water – **750 ml**
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Step 1: Marinate the Chicken

Take a large bowl.

Add:

- 2 kg chicken
- 1 tsp turmeric powder
- 1 tbsp ginger-garlic paste
- 1½ tsp salt

Mix thoroughly so every piece is coated.

Keep aside for **30 minutes**.

Step 2: Roast the Masala

Heat a dry pan on low flame.

Add:

- 4 tbsp coriander seeds
- 2 tsp fennel seeds
- 2 tsp cumin seeds
- 2 tsp black pepper
- 10–12 dry red chilies
- 4 cloves
- 2 cardamoms
- 2-inch cinnamon

Roast for **3–4 minutes**, stirring continuously.

Now add:

- 50 g grated coconut

Roast for another **2–3 minutes** until light golden.

Turn off the heat.

Cool completely.

Step 3: Grind the Masala

Transfer roasted ingredients to a mixer.

Add:

- 100 ml water

Grind into a smooth thick paste.

Keep aside.

Step 4: Fry the Onions

Heat **4 tbsp oil** in a large kadai.

Add:

- 20–25 curry leaves

Let them splutter.

Add:

- 700 g chopped onions

Cook on medium flame for **12–15 minutes**.

Stir frequently.

The onions should become deep golden brown.

This step is very important for flavor.

Step 5: Add Ginger-Garlic Paste

Add:

- Remaining 1 tbsp ginger-garlic paste

Cook for **2 minutes** until the raw smell disappears.

Step 6: Add Tomatoes

Add:

- 500 g chopped tomatoes

Mix well.

Cook for **8–10 minutes**.

Mash the tomatoes while cooking.

Continue until they become soft and oil begins separating.

Step 7: Add Ground Masala

Add the prepared Chettinad masala paste.

Mix thoroughly.

Cook on medium flame for **5–7 minutes**.

Keep stirring to prevent sticking.

The oil should start appearing around the edges.

Step 8: Add the Chicken

Add the marinated chicken.

Mix well so every piece is coated with masala.

Cook uncovered for **8–10 minutes**.

The chicken will release moisture.

Step 9: Add Water

Pour:

- **750 ml hot water**

Add:

- Remaining salt (about 2½–3 tsp, or according to taste)

Mix thoroughly.

Step 10: Simmer

Cover the kadai.

Cook on low-medium flame for **30–35 minutes**.

Open and stir every 10 minutes.

The chicken should become tender and the gravy should thicken.

If the gravy becomes too thick:

- Add 100–200 ml hot water.
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Step 11: Final Finishing

Add:

- Chopped coriander leaves

Mix gently.

Turn off the heat.

Let the curry rest for **15–20 minutes** before serving.

Expected Result

- Spicy, aromatic gravy
- Strong black pepper and fennel flavor
- Thick restaurant-style consistency
- No butter, cream, or unhealthy additives
- Serves **8 people** with rice, chapati, neer dosa, or parotta

Shopping List

- Chicken 2 kg
- Onions 700 g
- Tomatoes 500 g
- Ginger 50 g
- Garlic 50 g
- Fresh coconut 50 g
- Curry leaves 1 bunch
- Coriander leaves 1 bunch
- Coriander seeds 32 g
- Fennel seeds 8 g
- Cumin seeds 8 g
- Black pepper 8 g
- Dry red chilies 10–12
- Cloves 4
- Cardamom 2
- Cinnamon 1 stick
- Turmeric powder
- Salt
- Cooking oil 60 ml

This will give you an authentic, flavorful Chicken Chettinad suitable for a family meal of 8 people. 🍗🔥